

# CLUB/STATE TEAM OF THE YEAR



## Puneri Paltan

### *Discipline: Kabaddi*

Puneri Paltan was often the underachiever of the Pro Kabaddi League with bottom-of-the-table and mid-table finishes over the years. But its faith in its academy system started providing results when it finished runner-up in the 2022 season before it went all the way in 2023-24 to clinch its maiden PKL title. Such was

its dominance last year that it only lost twice – the least number of defeats since the introduction of the 22-game league stage in 2017 – in the entire campaign. Puneri Paltan's strong showing over the season put the team in the argument for being the greatest in the league's history.

#### **Achievements in the 2023-24 season:**

- ✦ Won its maiden PKL title with a league-record 96 points in the round-robin stage
- ✦ Paltan lost just twice in the campaign – a league record.



## Goa Challengers TTC

### *Discipline: Table Tennis*

Goa Challengers TTC became the first team in Ultimate Table Tennis history to win the title in two consecutive seasons. With two new teams in the fray, the Harmeet Desai-led Goa rode the pressure of defending champions to make it to the playoffs, despite scoring just 37 points in the league stage. During the final, Goa lost key paddler Diya Chitale to injury and didn't have an injury replacement. But her teammates didn't let the side feel her absence as they wrapped up the title by the second match of the night.

#### **Achievements in the 2023-24 season:**

- ✦ First UTT team to win successive titles
- ✦ Won the title despite scoring just 37 points and finishing fourth in the league stage

